

Haryana and Punjab always dominate India's Olympic contingent

After a long gap, the share of participants from Tamil Nadu among India's Olympians reached the 10% mark in the 2024 Paris edition

DATA POINT

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For the second consecutive edition, sportspersons from Haryana and Punjab form the largest share of India's Olympians. In the last five Olympics, Haryana has consistently been on top of the chart, contributing between 15% and 22% of India's contenders.

Punjab contributed the highest share of contenders in the 2000 and 2004 Olympics, and the second highest share in the 2012, 2020, and 2024 editions. In 2016, Kerala contributed the second highest share. In 2008, Punjab was tied with three other States in contributing the second highest share.

For the first time since 2000, Tamil Nadu reached the 10% mark in 2024 – the third highest contributor State this year. There has been a marked drop in participation from Kerala in the latest two editions. Undivided Andhra Pradesh (AP), Karnataka, Maharashtra, and Uttar Pradesh have sent a significant number of sportspersons to the Olympics over the years. Despite being a relatively small State, Manipur has contributed 4%-5% of India's Olympians for most years (**Table 1**).

In the 2000-2024 period, in all the editions of the Olympics put together, the share of women contenders from Manipur and undivided AP was higher than men (**Table 2**). The share of women contenders was higher in judo, weightlifting, archery, athletics, and badminton in this period (**Table 3**). A year-wise analysis shows that India came close to achieving gender parity only in the 2016 Olympics (**Table 4**).

Table 5 shows the State-wise share of Olympians under each sport. Of India's participants under the wrestling category, 88% were from Haryana (2000-2024).

State-wise representation at the Olympics

The tables are based on data gathered from World Athletics, the Indian Olympic Association, and the Paris 2024 Olympics website. All figures are presented as percentages. Only select States are depicted in these tables. Some States were excluded in certain tables because of a lack of contenders or because they had too few to be categorised by gender or sport



Table 1 | The State-wise share of Olympians across editions

State	2000	2004	2008	2012	2016	2020	2024
Haryana	4%	15%	16%	16%	18%	22%	21%
Punjab	15%	17%	9%	13%	9%	15%	16%
T.N.	13%	2%	4%	1%	4%	6%	10%
U.P.	6%	11%	5%	12%	6%	9%	8%
Andhra*	6%	2%	7%	4%	6%	4%	7%
Karnataka	6%	9%	9%	11%	9%	5%	6%
Delhi	4%		9%		1%	3%	4%
Kerala	13%	11%	9%	8%	11%	6%	4%
Maharashtra	8%	11%	5%	4%	6%	6%	4%
Gujarat					1%	2%	2%
M.P.	2%		2%		1%	3%	2%
Manipur	4%		4%	5%	5%	4%	2%
Odisha	6%	7%		4%	5%	3%	2%
Rajasthan	2%		7%	1%	2%	4%	2%
W.B.	4%	4%	7%	8%	5%	3%	2%

Table 2 | State-wise gender-split of Olympians

State	Female	Male
Manipur	71%	29%
Andhra*	61%	39%
Rajasthan	47%	53%
Haryana	44%	56%
W.B.	44%	56%
Maharashtra	41%	59%
Karnataka	41%	59%
Gujarat	40%	60%
Odisha	40%	60%
Kerala	38%	63%
U.P.	33%	67%
M.P.	25%	75%
T.N.	24%	76%
Punjab	20%	80%

Table 3 | Gender-wise split of Olympians across sports

Sport type	Female	Male
Judo	86%	14%
Weightlifting	67%	33%
Archery	58%	42%
Athletics	52%	48%
Badminton	52%	48%
Wrestling	46%	54%
Golf	45%	55%
Table tennis	44%	56%
Tennis	43%	57%
Shooting	39%	61%
Swimming	29%	71%
Boxing	24%	76%
Hockey	14%	86%
Rowing	10%	90%

Table 4 | Gender-wise split of Olympians across editions

Year	Female	Male
2000	37%	63%
2004	37%	63%
2008	43%	57%
2012	29%	71%
2016	48%	52%
2020	35%	65%
2024	40%	60%

The share of women contenders was high in judo, weightlifting, and archery. Only the 2016 Olympics came very close to achieving gender parity

Table 5 | The table shows the State-wise share of Olympians under each sport in the 2000 to 2024 period cumulatively. *Andhra Pradesh refers to the undivided State

State	Archery	Athletics	Badminton	Boxing	Golf	Hockey	Judo	Rowing	Sailing	Shooting	Swimming	TT	Tennis	Weightlifting	Wrestling
Andhra Pradesh*	3%	3%	34%	3%		2%				3%		17	25	11%	
Assam	3%			12%											
Delhi	3%	2%	3%				14%			7%	7%	23			4%
Gujarat						1%					7%	11	4%		
Haryana	3%	13%	7%	58%	18%	14%	14%	10%		15%	7%		7%		88%
Jharkhand	27%			6%		1%									
Karnataka		8%	17%		36%	7%			14%	2%	50%	6	14%		
Kerala		26%	3%			4%					14%				
Maharashtra	6%	3%	21%		18%	6%		10%		11%	7%		11%		
Manipur	12%			6%		6%	43%							56%	
Odisha		3%				11%								11%	
Punjab		12%		3%	9%	30%	14%	20%	14%	21%					
Rajasthan		3%						30%		11%					
Tamil Nadu		7%				2%			71%	6%		17	18%	22%	
Uttar Pradesh	6%	9%	7%	9%	9%	10%	14%	20%		11%					8%
Uttarakhand		5%	3%					10%		2%					
West Bengal	18%	3%			9%	1%				3%		28	14%		

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